

Killer rigs

We tell you about the best components to look for at various PC rigs at different budgets

Price watch

This it's all about high end gaming laptops and LED TVs under the price bracket of ₹1lakh.

Laptop tradeoffs



Unless you have limitless money, laptop buying isn't without its fair share of compromises. Here are a few popular ones.

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For business: Slim and light or rock solid dependability?

Business notebooks can't just be the same as consumer notebooks, because businesses have special needs and need to tow the compliance line. Business notebooks need to be full of all the bells and whistles that most consumer notebooks offer, but not at the cost of safety, security and dependability – three key traits of any self-respecting business laptop.

A notebook can't be slim and light and offer rock solid build quality and dependable performance at the same time. A thin and light business notebook is generally a premium ultraportable, which doesn't sell for cheap, weighs less than 1.5 kg with around 10 mm thickness. It may compromise on larger battery capacity or great build quality to prioritize on its aesthetic appeal and size-zero figure. Safe and secure or cute looks? Flaunt an expensive toy or something on a tight budget? Decision time!

In a business notebook, sometimes you would have to settle for a less than ideal

CPU, RAM, HDD, and form factor combo just to keep the costs down. Or sometimes you'd have to do that just to ensure certain critical extra features are supported by the notebook. Stuff like TPM or Trusted Platform Module chip which hardware encrypts all sensitive data on the laptop; remote maintenance and laptop management tools like Lenovo ThinkVantage suite built into the system; HD 720p webcam with directional microphone for better quality video conference calls; and more.

For students: Something cheap for note taking or a high performance laptop?

Do you need all-day battery to take notes in class or desire lightning quick performance to edit videos? Choose the right alternative to ace through school. When it comes to a laptop, school student's needs are varied. They can be as simple as taking notes all day long during lectures (for which battery life is important) or working on multi-

media-rich presentations that require great performance. It's also their multimedia machine, stereo system, and hostel all-rounder.

One of the trade-offs to consider while buying a laptop for school is whether you want great battery life or better all-round performance. Up to six hours of usage off a single charge or the ability to work on graphics design, video editing or animation and rendering apps (that require faster components like Core i5 CPU, 8GB RAM, 7200rpm HDD, 2GB GPU, etc).

Portability vs versatility is another consideration. A 10-inch netbook with a weak Intel Atom or Core i3 chip won't let you do a whole lot, but it's convenient to carry around campus and keep it in your backpack for note-taking in class. But the same netbook will be too slow for doing other things like HD movie watching sessions, good quality audio, LAN gaming sessions (on medium settings), etc., for which a 15-inch or 17-inch desktop replacement laptop – which is largely confined to your dorm room – is obviously more preferable.

Windows OS vs Linux OS is another trade-off and it's purely a cost-based consideration. Microsoft Windows operating system offers familiarity of use but also affects final cost of the laptop by 3-4k. Linux OSes (like Ubuntu, Kubuntu, Elementary, Mynt) are a free workaround, but not for absolute beginners. Chrome OS (on Chromebooks) are another cloud-based OS alternative to consider. Anything that helps cut cost for a cash-strapped student, right?

Good looking laptop just for your living room or high on functionality?

Choosing a laptop for home use isn't as easy as it looks. Laptop to replace your home desktop PC or to complement